

quality of these bonds or any stocks they sold, but rather in that day of a seller's market they gratefully accepted any part of a syndicate offered them by their New York associates or by the large investment banking houses. Then the security salesmen for the bank would portray to their customers that they had a statistical department capable of surveying those customers' holdings and issuing to them a report on each security handled. What was actually done in those "security analyses" was to look up the data on a particular company in one of the established manuals of the day, such as *Moody's* or *Standard Statistics*. Then someone like myself, with no further knowledge than what was reported in that manual, would simply paraphrase the wording of the manual to write his own report. Any company that was doing a large volume of sales was invariably reported as "well managed," just because it was big. I was under no direct orders to recommend that customers switch some of the securities I "analyzed" into whatever security the bank was attempting to sell at the moment, but the whole atmosphere was one of encouraging this type of analysis.